

Markscheme

Mathematics: analysis and approaches

Practice question bank

16. (a)

Consider the function $f(x) = \frac{5x + 3}{(x + 2)(x - 5)}$.

Write $f(x)$ as the sum of partial fractions in the form $\frac{A}{x + 2} + \frac{B}{x - 5}$.

$$5x + 3 = A(x - 5) + B(x + 2) \quad (M1)$$

$$\text{substituting } x = -2: -7 = -7A \Rightarrow A = 1 \quad \mathbf{A1}$$

$$\text{substituting } x = 5: 28 = 7B \Rightarrow B = 4 \quad \mathbf{A1}$$

[3 marks]